AUTOCOMMAND AI MARKETPLACE

Complete Company Creation Project Book

Digital Vehicle Acquisition, Financing, Protection, Worldwide Shipping, Podcast Marketing, and Onsite Dealership Operating Plan

Working Purpose

This document is written as a practical formation and execution book for launching AutoCommand AI Marketplace as a digital-first vehicle acquisition platform supported by a physical New Bern/Raleigh-area dealership, investor participation program, podcast marketing engine, Agentic AI system, dealer inventory network, financing process, ancillary protection products, worldwide shipping, and retention-income model.

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Executive Summary and Formation Thesis

AutoCommand AI Marketplace is intended to be formed as a digital-first automotive acquisition company that helps customers locate, evaluate, finance, protect, purchase, and ship used vehicles through one coordinated platform. The company will not be limited to a traditional used-car lot and will not rely solely on owned inventory. Its strength is the combination of a market-wide digital search platform, a human-assisted concierge sales process, dealer and auction relationships, financing access, ancillary product revenue, shipping coordination, retention income, podcast-driven awareness, and a modest but credible onsite dealership operation in the New Bern/Raleigh, North Carolina corridor.

The business should be built around one simple customer promise: the customer can search by brand, model, year, mileage, price, monthly payment, domestic availability, international availability, shipping preference, and protection preference; the system will then pull qualified prospects, rank them, attach vehicle-history information such as Carfax or an equivalent report, present financing choices, offer protection products, confirm dealer availability, coordinate the purchase path, and arrange delivery or shipment. The desired user experience should be simple enough for a non-automotive consumer to complete an initial search in under five minutes, while powerful enough for the business to manage dealer negotiation, finance routing, documentation, shipping, and post-sale customer retention.

The onsite dealership is not an afterthought. It interrelates directly with the digital platform by giving the company a real operating base, customer trust, state licensing path, dealer credibility, access to local buyers, vehicle delivery and pickup capability, a location for limited owned inventory, and a place to handle trades, inspection, documentation, and customer handoff. The digital platform supplies demand and market reach; the onsite dealership supplies credibility, transactional authority, inventory control, and physical execution. The company should start digitally with paid vehicle search and buying-assist services, while preparing the onsite location within the first thirty days. The onsite location should begin with approximately eight to twelve vehicles and scale cautiously to fifteen to twenty vehicles by ninety days, twenty to twenty-five vehicles by six months, and twenty-five to forty vehicles by twelve months only if turn rate, cash, inventory quality, and staff capacity justify it.

The company's financial model is designed to earn from multiple sources. Revenue should come from customer search fees, buying concierge fees, dealer success fees, finance and F&I revenue where lawful, wheel and tire protection, road-hazard protection, destination and transit protection, 30-day, 60-day, and 90-day limited repair protection programs, extended service contracts, GAP products where available and compliant, domestic and worldwide shipping coordination, auction-assist fees, international sourcing fees, self-financed inventory/floorplan yield, onsite retail margin, consignment revenue, trade-in revenue, and retention programs. The goal is to reach at least $10 million in annual vehicle transaction volume, which at an average $25,000 vehicle transaction equals approximately 400 units annually, or roughly thirty-four units per month.

The key discipline is to avoid launching as an expensive, overstocked dealership. The company should launch as a lean digital command center with a small onsite dealership component. Initial operations should be managed by a core team of two people, with no more than five total operating participants during the first six months unless revenue justifies expansion. The company should use contractors, trade partners, vendors, and Dr. Shetty's technical team to reduce fixed payroll. Staff should be added only when lead volume, dealer relationships, financing applications, onsite inventory, and monthly unit count prove the need.

This book is drafted as an operating and formation document, not as a substitute for securities counsel, dealer licensing counsel, tax counsel, consumer finance compliance review, insurance licensing review, or final contract drafting. The investor program, protection products, finance workflows, repair protection language, influencer agreements, and any revenue-sharing arrangements must be approved by qualified counsel before use.

Core Thesis Component	Business Meaning
Digital platform	The customer searches, compares, prequalifies, selects, clicks to buy, and tracks the deal through a simple customer-facing dashboard.
Onsite dealership	The physical location supports licensing, credibility, local deliveries, limited owned inventory, test drives, paperwork, trade-ins, and customer trust.
Dealer inventory network	The company profits by moving other dealers' vehicles without owning every car.
Agentic AI system	Dr. Shetty's team builds the automated engine for search, scoring, finance routing, dealer communication, shipping, compliance, CRM, and investor reporting.

Podcast marketing engine	Bill Henderson, Steven Burch, guests, creators, and influencers educate buyers and promote the brand while the technology comes online.
Revenue stack	The company earns from customer fees, dealer fees, finance, protection, shipping, onsite inventory, retention, floorplan yield, and international sourcing.

Front-End Podcast Marketing Program

The podcast program should be placed at the front end of AutoCommand AI because it gives the business a low-cost way to explain the product, build public trust, educate consumers, attract investors, attract dealer partners, and begin creating brand awareness before the full Agentic AI platform is complete. Bill Henderson and Steven Burch should be positioned as the founding voices of the series, with the option to add guest hosts, consumer advocates, dealership professionals, finance experts, shipping partners, and credible automotive influencers. The podcast should not be treated as entertainment only; it should be treated as a business-development channel that feeds the website, the CRM, the investor campaign, the dealer-partner campaign, and the customer lead funnel.

The recommended series title is “The AutoCommand Show” or “AutoCommand AI: The Smarter Car Buying Podcast.” The tone should be direct, consumer-friendly, professional, and protective. The audience should feel that the company is on the buyer’s side while also being fair to good dealerships that want to move inventory honestly. The series should explain how buyers can avoid being taken advantage of, how financing actually works, how add-ons are sold, how to compare vehicles, how shipping changes the real cost of a car, how domestic and international trends affect prices, and how AutoCommand AI simplifies the entire buying process.

The earlier concept of using a “nice looking young lady” as a guest or spokesperson should be refined into a professional and compliant brand role. The company should recruit a polished, credible, approachable consumer-facing host or recurring guest who can speak clearly about ease of use, consumer confidence, family buying decisions, first-time buyers, payment concerns, and how to avoid dealership pressure. Her value should be based on credibility, communication skill, audience trust, and brand fit, not appearance alone. This protects the company’s image and avoids unnecessary employment, discrimination, or brand-reputation problems.

The podcast should include a recurring “Do Tell” segment. This segment should deliver practical insider-style education without defaming dealers or making unsupported accusations. The segment can cover red flags such as hidden add-ons, unclear dealer fees, payment packing, inflated service contracts, mismatched mileage, title brands, transport-risk mistakes, auction misunderstandings, and the difference between a low advertised price and a real out-the-door price. The purpose is to teach consumers what to ask, what to verify, and when to walk away. Each episode should end by showing how AutoCommand AI handles that issue through search, scoring, financing, protection, and documentation.

The podcast launch should occur immediately and should run simultaneously with Dr. Shetty’s technical build. The early episodes do not require a studio. Bill and Steve can begin with a low-cost setup consisting of two quality USB microphones, two webcams or phones, a laptop, simple lighting, Riverside, StreamYard, Zoom, or a similar recording tool, and a podcast hosting platform. Audio and video clips should be repurposed into YouTube Shorts, TikTok, Instagram Reels, Facebook Reels, LinkedIn clips, email content, blog posts, dealer outreach clips, and investor updates. Podcast distribution can be handled through a host that publishes by RSS to Apple Podcasts, Spotify, YouTube, Amazon Music, and other podcast directories; current podcast hosting services commonly advertise one-click or RSS-based distribution to major platforms, including Apple Podcasts, Spotify, Amazon Music, and YouTube.

The podcast should not wait for perfection. The first ten episodes should be recorded with a simple brand graphic, a clean background, a clear disclaimer, and a call to action directing viewers to the AutoCommand AI vehicle selector or waitlist. Each episode should create a lead pathway: “Upload a car you are considering,” “Get a free AI price check,” “Join the launch list,” “Apply to be a dealer partner,” or “Ask us to find your vehicle.” This connects the media effort directly to revenue and CRM growth.

The company should use the onsite dealership as part of the podcast marketing method. Episodes should be filmed from the lot, the delivery area, the finance desk, the vehicle photo area, and the customer consultation table. As inventory begins to arrive, the team should film short vehicle walkarounds, “why this car scored well” segments, “how shipping changes total cost” segments, and “what we would ask the dealer before buying this” segments. This makes the onsite operation visible and helps the public understand that AutoCommand AI is not just a website; it is a real operating dealership and acquisition platform.

Podcast Segment	Purpose	Revenue/Brand Connection
Find My Car	Bill and Steve review a customer-style search request and show how the platform would locate matching vehicles.	Drives search-fee leads and demonstrates platform simplicity.
Do Tell	Consumer-protection segment explaining what buyers should watch for in pricing, finance, fees, title, mileage, and add-ons.	Builds trust and differentiates AutoCommand as a buyer-side advocate.
Dealer Reality Check	Explains how good dealers can benefit by working with AutoCommand and moving real inventory to qualified buyers.	Supports dealer partner recruitment and dealer success-fee revenue.
Finance Without Confusion	Explains APR, loan term, payment, down payment, credit tiers, prequalification, and lender choices.	Feeds finance applications and reduces customer anxiety.
Shipping the Smart Way	Shows how local, national, enclosed, port, and worldwide shipping can change the best buying decision.	Supports shipping-margin revenue and national reach.
Domestic and International Trends	Discusses pricing, supply, used EVs, SUVs, trucks, export demand, and national/international inventory movement.	Positions the company as market-aware and scalable.
Lot Walk	Films from the onsite dealership and explains why particular units were selected for inventory.	Builds physical credibility and onsite sales interest.
Investor Update	Provides business progress, dealer count, leads, units, inventory, platform development, and revenue milestones.	Supports investor confidence and transparency.

Recommended Influencer and Creator Targets

Influencer outreach should begin with a mix of national automotive creators and lower-cost regional micro-influencers. The national names should be treated as aspirational targets, while the immediate budget should prioritize regional creators, dealership personalities, family finance creators, military-family creators, truck/SUV reviewers, and consumer-education creators in North Carolina, Virginia, South Carolina, Georgia, Florida, and the broader Southeast. Every paid or compensated endorsement must clearly disclose the relationship. The FTC’s endorsement guidance requires material connections between advertisers and endorsers to be disclosed clearly and conspicuously; therefore, AutoCommand should require written influencer agreements, approval rights over claims, and disclosure language such as “paid partnership,” “sponsored,” or “ad” where appropriate.

Influencer/Creator Category	Example Names or Targets	Recommended Use
Automotive consumer education	CarEdge / Ray and Zach Shefska; The Car Mom; Scotty Kilmer	Explain car-buying protection, price checks, and finance simplicity.
Automotive entertainment/review	Doug DeMuro; Hoovie’s Garage; Tavarish; Donut Media; The Fast Lane Car	Large awareness campaigns if budget permits.
Women/family car-buying audience	The Car Mom; regional mom/family creators; Raleigh and coastal NC lifestyle creators	Promote ease of use, family confidence, safety, and not being taken advantage of.
Truck and work-vehicle audience	Regional truck creators, contractor creators, fleet/service business creators	Promote trucks, work vehicles, and small-business vehicle acquisition.
Finance/credit education	Budgeting, credit-repair, and personal finance creators with automotive relevance	Explain financing choices, prequalification, payment discipline, and protection products.
Local trust builders	New Bern, Raleigh, Greenville, Wilmington, and military-community micro-influencers	Drive affordable lead generation during launch.

Low-Cost Podcast Launch Budget

The podcast should be launched for low cost and should not consume investor funds that are needed for licensing, CRM, dealer outreach, and customer acquisition. The first ninety days should be treated as a proof-of-audience period. The goal is to record weekly long-form episodes and daily short clips, not to build a professional studio. The company can upgrade equipment only after leads and conversions justify it.

Item	Launch Cost Range	Purpose
Two USB microphones	$150-$400	Clear voice quality for Bill and Steve.
Two webcams or modern smartphones	$0-$300	Video capture for YouTube and clips.
Basic lights and stands	$100-$300	Professional appearance without studio buildout.
Recording platform	$0-$100/month	Remote guest interviews and recordings.
Podcast hosting	$0-$50/month	RSS feed and distribution to major podcast directories.
Clip editing contractor	$250-$750/month	Short-form social clips from long episodes.
Graphic templates	$0-$150	Show cover, thumbnails, lower thirds, social posts.
Initial paid boost	$500-$1,500/month	Promote best-performing clips and lead magnets.

Section Two - Platform and Onsite Dealership Business Plan

AutoCommand AI Marketplace must be built as one business with two interlocking operating sides: the digital acquisition platform and the onsite dealership. The digital platform creates reach, customer convenience, market-wide inventory access, financing speed, and AI-powered decision support. The onsite dealership creates credibility, licensing, inventory control, test-drive and delivery capability, document control, local sales, trade-in intake, auction capability, and physical proof of business. Neither side should be treated as optional. The company becomes more credible because it has a real location, and the location becomes more profitable because the digital platform supplies demand beyond the lot.

The customer-facing platform should operate through a structured selector rather than a vague open-text prompt. The customer should choose brand, model, year, mileage, vehicle type, price range, monthly payment, down payment, trade-in, credit profile, location, domestic or international availability, shipping preference, and protection interest. The platform should also accept natural language, but natural language should be converted into structured search criteria. For example, when a customer enters “Find me a 2021 to 2024 Toyota Highlander under 60,000 miles with financing and shipping to Raleigh,” the system should convert that into a Toyota brand filter, Highlander model filter, 2021-2024 year range, under 60,000 mileage filter, Raleigh delivery point, financing flag, and shipping workflow.

The platform should then pull market-wide prospects from approved or lawful sources. The preferred inventory sources are direct dealer partner feeds, franchise dealer used inventory, independent dealer inventory, auction partner inventory, wholesale lists, customer-submitted links, consignment listings, and AutoCommand-owned inventory. Public marketplace sites such as Cars.com, Autotrader, CarGurus, TrueCar, dealer websites, and auction platforms can be used for market awareness and customer-directed listing review, but scalable operations should rely on authorized feeds, dealer agreements, APIs, affiliate relationships, or dealer-uploaded inventory. The company should not base its technology on unauthorized scraping because that creates legal and operational risk.

Each vehicle should receive a scorecard before it is recommended. The scorecard should include price versus market, mileage value, year and trim value, title and accident risk, dealer reliability, financing fit, protection product eligibility, shipping-adjusted total cost, export eligibility when relevant, negotiation opportunity, and overall recommendation. The customer should not be shown a confusing dump of hundreds of cars. The customer should receive curated categories: best overall match, best price, lowest payment, best local option, best shipped option, best warranty/protection fit, best export-ready option, best auction opportunity, and best negotiation opportunity.

Every recommended vehicle should include Carfax or an equivalent vehicle-history review before final purchase recommendation. The business should make this a brand standard. The platform can say that no recommended vehicle moves to final purchase review without title-status review, mileage consistency review, accident/history review, dealer confirmation, and customer approval. This creates trust and protects the company from preventable reputation damage.

The onsite dealership must be presented as the physical execution arm of the digital platform. The onsite dealership receives customers who want in-person support, holds selected owned inventory, handles test drives, delivers vehicles, manages documents, stores titles and deal jackets, coordinates inspections, manages trades, supports auction purchases, and gives the podcast and social-media program a real place to film. Customers who buy digitally may still pick up at the dealership, sign documents at the dealership, or have their vehicle shipped from dealer to customer. The onsite location should not be overloaded with inventory because the digital platform’s value is market-wide selection. The lot should act as a trust center, delivery center, limited inventory center, photo/video center, and transaction-control center.

Customer Use Flow

The customer flow should be intentionally simple. The customer searches, the system scores, the customer prequalifies, the customer selects protection options, the customer clicks to buy, and the backend automatically launches dealer confirmation, financing, Carfax/history attachment, shipping, document preparation, compliance review, and customer updates. The entire experience should feel like ordering a vehicle acquisition service, not entering a dealership negotiation trap.

Customer Step	What the Customer Sees	What the Backend Does
Search	Brand, model, year, mileage, budget, payment, location, domestic/international, and shipping filters.	Creates CRM lead, stores search profile, triggers inventory search agent.
Compare	Curated vehicles by best match, price, payment, local, shipped, and protection fit.	Normalizes inventory data, scores vehicles, attaches history report status.
Finance	Up to five financing choices where available, with clear prequalification versus approval language.	Routes to finance partners, logs consent, tracks lender status, protects data.
Protect	Wheel/tire, road hazard, destination protection, 30/60/90-day repair support, service contract, and GAP options.	Displays optional product terms, exclusions, premiums, and provider details.
Click to Buy	Customer confirms preferred vehicle and authorizes next steps.	Creates transaction file, notifies manager, contacts dealer, starts documents, shipping, and compliance review.
Deliver	Customer sees pickup, local delivery, national transport, or international shipping status.	Coordinates carrier, bill of lading, delivery checklist, photos, and acceptance.
Retain	Customer receives maintenance, protection renewal, referral, and trade-cycle offers.	CRM triggers follow-up campaigns and retention-income opportunities.

Onsite Dealership Interrelationship

The onsite dealership is the conversion and confidence engine for the digital platform. When the digital platform identifies a customer and vehicle, the onsite team can decide whether to let the dealer sell the vehicle directly, broker or assist the purchase, buy the vehicle into AutoCommand inventory, consign it, transfer it dealer-to-dealer, or ship it directly to the customer. This is how AutoCommand can move inventory without buying every vehicle and still earn profit from the transaction. The onsite location also allows the company to maintain a small inventory of attractive vehicles for immediate sale, use vehicles as podcast and social content, support local customers, and take trades that can be wholesaled, retailed, or used as inventory.

Transaction Path	Who Owns Vehicle Before Sale	How AutoCommand Earns	Role of Onsite Dealership
Dealer-direct assisted purchase	Third-party dealer	Customer buying fee, dealer success fee, financing, protection, shipping.	Reviews deal, supports customer, may deliver or coordinate paperwork.
AutoCommand-owned retail sale	AutoCommand	Retail margin, finance/F&I, protection products, shipping, retention.	Displays or stores vehicle, handles test drive, documents, delivery.
Consignment sale	Customer or dealer consignor	Consignment fee, finance, protection, shipping.	Photographs, markets, manages buyer and delivery.
Auction-assist purchase	Auction/consignor until sale	Auction fee, buying fee, transport, protection, possible retail margin.	Uses dealer credentials where applicable, inspects and delivers.
International/export transaction	Dealer, AutoCommand, or consignor	International sourcing fee, export coordination, shipping margin, protection where available.	Coordinates document control, inspection, port delivery, and customer communication.

Vehicle Protection and Ancillary Services

Ancillary products should be embedded in the platform at the protection stage and should never be sold as confusing or hidden add-ons. The customer should see optional choices with clear prices, limits, exclusions, provider names, and claims procedures. The 30-day, 60-day, and 90-day repair-support programs should be limited to up to $1,000 in covered repairs at different premiums. They should be reviewed by counsel and either backed by a third-party service-contract administrator, documented as a limited dealer-backed protection program, or structured as a clearly disclosed limited repair reimbursement program. They should not be called insurance unless licensed insurance providers and compliant forms are used.

Protection Product	Suggested Premium	Business Purpose
30-Day Delivery Confidence Plan - up to $1,000 repair support	$249-$399	Low-cost trust builder for lower-risk domestic purchases.
60-Day Enhanced Confidence Plan - up to $1,000 repair support	$399-$599	Better fit for shipped vehicles and mid-mileage units.
90-Day Premium Confidence Plan - up to $1,000 repair support	$599-$899	Higher perceived value for more expensive or long-distance vehicles.
Wheel and Tire Protection	$699-$1,299 bundled range	High-attachment product for trucks, SUVs, luxury vehicles, and road-hazard buyers.
Destination/Transit Protection	Variable by route and value	Supports local, national, enclosed, port, and international delivery confidence.
Extended Service Contract	Provider-priced	Longer-term protection and recurring customer confidence.
GAP Coverage	Provider-priced, where lawful	Finance-product attachment for eligible customers.

Section Three - Equipment, Systems, Hardware, Programming, CRM, Market Trends, and Staffing

The business should be built with professional systems from day one, but the first phase should not waste money on enterprise tools before revenue is proven. The minimum system must include a website or web app, CRM, customer intake forms, inventory tracking, e-signature, payment processing, secure document storage, accounting software, marketing automation, shipping quote workflow, and a basic dashboard. As the company grows, it should add dealer portal functions, customer dashboards, AI-powered vehicle scoring, finance integrations, auction watchlists, inventory feeds, and dealer management software.

The used-car market remains large, supply-constrained, and well suited to a buyer-assist model. Cox Automotive's 2026 used-vehicle outlook revised retail used-vehicle sales to approximately 20.4 million units, and recent used-vehicle inventory reporting showed tight days' supply and average listing prices around the mid-$25,000 range. These market conditions support AutoCommand's focus on vehicles generally above $10,000 and preferably in the $18,000 to $55,000 range because those vehicles can support financing, protection products, shipping, and customer fees.

The company should maintain a clean and secure operating environment because it will handle customer identity, finance information, vehicle documents, payment information, and possibly nonpublic personal information. The FTC Safeguards Rule applies to many automobile dealers who finance or lease vehicles, and the business should build written information security, access controls, employee permissions, vendor controls, multi-factor authentication, secure document storage, and incident response into the operating model from the start.

Office and Location Equipment

Equipment	Launch Quantity	Operating Purpose
Reception desk	1	Customer entry and professional first impression.
Sales/consultation desks	2 initially	Customer vehicle review, deal presentation, and buyer support.
Private finance/closing desk or office	1	Credit discussions, document signing, privacy-sensitive meetings.
Manager desk	1	General management, investor calls, dealer approvals.
Conference table	1	Investor meetings, dealer meetings, staff meetings, customer consultations.
Guest chairs	8-10 initially	Reception, consultation, and delivery waiting area.
Locking file cabinets	2-3 initially	Deal jackets, customer records, compliance files.
Fireproof safe	1	Titles, checks, key documents, sensitive items.
Secure shredder	1	Privacy and document disposal.
Printer/scanner/copier	1-2	Deal documents, licensing files, customer paperwork.
Interior and exterior signage	As required	Branding, dealer licensing visibility, customer navigation.

Systems Hardware

Hardware	Launch Quantity	Purpose
Business laptops/desktops	4-6	Founder, operations, sales, finance/admin, marketing/CRM.
Dual monitors	4-6	CRM, inventory search, finance screens, document work.
Tablets	2	Customer intake, delivery checklist, lot walkaround, e-signature support.
Smartphones	2-3	Vehicle photos, videos, customer updates, social content.
VoIP phones/headsets	3-5	Customer calls, dealer calls, finance and vendor coordination.
Large display screen	1	Customer vehicle comparisons and staff dashboard.
Secure router/firewall	1	Network and customer-data protection.
Backup internet hotspot	1	Business continuity.
Security camera system	1	Lot, office, and key-control security.
Alarm system	1	Theft prevention and insurance support.

Lot Equipment

The lot should be equipped to support presentation, security, delivery, and basic readiness. The business should not create an expensive service department during launch. It should use vendor relationships for inspection, detailing, tire work, wheel repair, body/cosmetic work, diagnostics, and reconditioning. The onsite equipment should be enough to present cars properly, document condition, and support delivery.

Lot Item	Purpose
Key lockbox or electronic key cabinet	Controls keys and prevents loss, theft, or unauthorized vehicle movement.
Vehicle key tags and stock numbers	Links vehicles to inventory records, CRM, and deal files.
Jump box and battery charger	Maintains lot vehicles and avoids poor customer presentation.
Tire inflator and tread gauge	Supports delivery checks and basic vehicle readiness.
OBD-II scanner	Provides basic diagnostic screening before customer delivery or vehicle intake.
Detail supplies and portable vacuum	Maintains presentation without operating a full detail shop.
Photo/video area	Creates consistent online listings and podcast/social content.
Security lighting and cameras	Protects inventory and supports insurance requirements.

CRM and Programming Requirements

The CRM is the operating spine of the company. Every lead, investor, dealer, vehicle, finance application, protection sale, shipping quote, document, and follow-up task should be tracked in the CRM. The company should not operate by text messages and loose spreadsheets once customers and investors are engaged. The CRM must track lead source, customer profile, search filters, vehicle matches, dealer responses, financing status, protection-product selections, shipping status, gross revenue, customer satisfaction, and referral follow-up.

CRM Stage	Purpose
New lead	Capture source and begin immediate follow-up.
Search completed	Store brand, model, year, mileage, price, payment, and location filters.
Vehicle matches generated	Attach scorecards and customer recommendations.
Financing requested	Route customer to prequalification or finance partner.
Dealer contacted	Document availability, OTD price, fees, and hold policy.
Click-to-buy received	Create formal transaction file and assign manager.
Documents generated	Track e-signature, disclosures, finance documents, shipping authorizations.
Vehicle shipped or delivered	Track bill of lading, photos, delivery acceptance, customer satisfaction.
Retention active	Schedule maintenance offers, protection renewal, trade-cycle review, referral request.

Section Four DHI Agentic AI Buildout

DHI role should be to create the technical architecture and Agentic AI operating system that allows AutoCommand AI to scale beyond manual car-buying assistance. The system should not be built as a generic chatbot. It should be built as a controlled automotive workflow engine with specialized agents for customer intake, vehicle search, inventory normalization, vehicle scoring, history review, financing, protection products, dealer communication, shipping, compliance, CRM, marketing, podcast content support, and investor reporting.

The engagement structure should use a defined engagement fee rather than an open-ended subscription during the earliest stage. This gives AutoCommand predictable cost and gives team a defined scope. After the MVP and workflow architecture are complete, the business should move into a lower monthly maintenance and improvement fee. This is more realistic for DHI and AutoCommand than committing to a large permanent technology subscription before revenue is proven.

DHI engagement includes a operational fee ongoing for each client paying for services. This is for architecture, workflow design, MVP specification, selector logic, CRM data map, and prototype support. Phase Two can be enhanced for MVP buildout, integration work, AI scoring, customer dashboard, and dealer workflow. Phase Three can be milestone-based or revenue-supported. After launch, maintenance should be budgeted at a defined percentage per month to maintain sufficient maintenance and growth of the systems, improvements, monitoring, and feature updates, with larger enhancements separately approved.

Agentic AI Workflow

The AI workflow should be designed as a series of controlled agents that produce outputs for human approval. The AI may recommend, draft, score, alert, summarize, and route tasks. It should not autonomously bind the company to a purchase, financing decision, auction bid, legal contract, warranty commitment, or customer credit action without documented human approval and customer authorization.

AI Agent	Function	Required Output
Customer Selector Agent	Captures brand, model, year, mileage, budget, payment, trade-in, credit profile, location, shipping, and protection preferences.	Structured buying profile and CRM lead.
Inventory Search Agent	Searches dealer feeds, partner inventory, lawful market references, auction inventory, consignment, and AutoCommand inventory.	Normalized vehicle prospect list.
Vehicle Scoring Agent	Scores value, mileage, title, history, dealer reliability, finance fit, protection fit, shipping-adjusted cost, and export eligibility.	Customer scorecard and internal recommendation.
Carfax/History Agent	Attaches or requests vehicle-history report and flags title, accident, mileage, recall, and ownership concerns.	Vehicle history summary and risk flag.
Finance Agent	Estimates payments, captures consent, routes prequalification, receives lender options, and presents up to five choices.	Finance menu and lender status.
Protection Product Agent	Presents 30/60/90-day repair support, wheel/tire, service contract, GAP, and destination protection.	Optional product menu with terms, limits, and pricing.
Dealer Agent	Requests availability, OTD price, fees, hold policy, add-ons, title status, and shipping release.	Dealer response log and deal recommendation.
Click-to-Buy Agent	Activates transaction file when customer clicks buy.	Manager task list, documents, finance, shipping, and compliance workflows.
Shipping Agent	Quotes local, national, enclosed, dealer-to-dealer, port, and worldwide shipping.	Shipping options, cost, ETA, carrier status.
Compliance Agent	Checks disclosures, finance consent, privacy, Used Car Rule, protection product wording, and document retention.	Compliance checklist and stop/go flags.
CRM/Investor Reporting Agent	Tracks leads, units, revenue, inventory turn, dealer partners, finance attachment, protection attachment, shipping, and retention.	Dashboards and investor updates.

Appendix C - Source Notes and Verification References

The following source notes were used to support current market, compliance, and operating assumptions. These references should be reviewed again with counsel and management before final investor offering, licensing submission, financing program launch, or customer-facing publication.

North Carolina DMV Minimum Dealer License Requirements, Form LT-415: https://connect.ncdot.gov/business/DMV/DMV%20Documents/LT-415%20Minimum%20Dealer%20License%20Requirements%20%28Rev.%2002-24%29.pdf

North Carolina Motor Vehicle Dealer and Manufacturer Regulation Manual: https://connect.ncdot.gov/business/DMV/DMV%20Documents/Dealer%20Rules%20and%20Regulation%20Manual.pdf

FTC Dealer’s Guide to the Used Car Rule: https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/dealers-guide-used-car-rule

FTC Buyers Guide sample / warranty and service contract language: https://www.ftc.gov/system/files/documents/plain-language/cfr_buyers_guides_english.pdf

FTC Automobile Dealers and the FTC Safeguards Rule FAQ: https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/automobile-dealers-ftcs-safeguards-rule-frequently-asked-questions

FTC Endorsement Guides / advertising disclosure guidance: https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/advertising-marketing/endorsements-influencers-reviews

Cox Automotive Q1 2026 Manheim Used Vehicle Value Index / used retail forecast: https://www.coxautoinc.com/insights/q1-2026-muvvi/

Cox Automotive March 2026 used-vehicle inventory report: https://www.coxautoinc.com/insights/used-vehicle-inventory-march-2026/

Cars.com public marketplace reference: https://www.cars.com/

Autotrader public marketplace reference: https://www.autotrader.com/

CarGurus public marketplace reference: https://www.cargurus.com/

TrueCar public marketplace reference: https://www.truecar.com/

Podcast hosting and distribution reference, RSS.com comparison: https://rss.com/blog/best-podcast-hosting-platforms/

Podcast hosting and distribution reference, Transistor 2026 comparison: https://transistor.fm/best-podcast-hosting-platform/

Podcast distribution reference, Libsyn: https://libsyn.com/